

PLAYS AND PLAYERS



Playwrights write stories, or plays, that are performed on stage by players, called actors and actresses. Molière and Shakespeare both lived more than 300 years ago but their plays, such as *L'Avare* and *Macbeth*, are still popular. Laurence Olivier, one of the last century's most famous actors, starred in *Henry V* by Shakespeare and also in more modern plays, such as *The Entertainer* by John Osborne. Like all good players, he could make an audience believe that what they are seeing is real, not just an act.



Happy ending
Plays that make people laugh are called comedies. Molière wrote many wonderful plays in the 17th century that are still funny today.

Sad ending
Tragedies are plays with sad endings. *Cat on a Hot Tin Roof* was written by Tennessee Williams and is a famous modern tragedy.



Not a word
Marcel Marceau was a famous French mime artist—he acts out stories without speaking.

The actor playing Romeo shows that he likes Juliet by giving her a rose.

The players wear costumes like those worn by rich Italians in the past.

